CASCADIA ANALYTICS

INVESTMENT SCORECARD

VST

Vistra Corp. (NYSE)

As-of: 23-Oct-2026 | Latest Filing: Q2 2026 (10-Q) | Currency: USD

$139.57 [Mkt 23-Oct-26]

Market Cap: $47.4B [Mkt 23-Oct-26]

Attractiveness Score



Confidence: **High** (0 pillars excluded)

Pillar Breakdown

1. Operating Quality — 75

Contracted nuclear PPAs with Meta and AWS provide multi-decade visibility. But 3.93x debt/equity and merchant exposure to ERCOT pricing keep quality in check. The hybrid model is the right strategy.

2. Recent Trend — 80

Q2 EBITDA +31% YoY, EPS beat, guidance at/above midpoint, 97% fleet availability in record heat. Operational execution is excellent.

3. Forward Growth — 75

Data center load growth (4-6% ERCOT), Helix JV with NVIDIA/KKR, nuclear uprates. The electricity demand thesis is structural, not cyclical.

4. Valuation — 72

At $139.57 vs $117.32 DCF base, -16% upside with a Hold rating. PEG 0.43 is deeply cheap. Stock -27% from highs on sentiment, not fundamentals. Classic reset opportunity.

5. Catalysts & Risk — 75

Q3 earnings, new PPA announcements, and continued buybacks ($6.5B since 2021, -30% share count) are positives. Leverage and ERCOT price softness are risks. Positive skew.

Investment Thesis

- **Contracted AI Power:** Vistra is the purest play on data center electricity demand: 1,200 MW AWS PPA (Comanche Peak), 2,609 MW Meta PPAs (PJM nuclear), and the Helix JV with KKR and NVIDIA. Customers are contracting before regulations are settled [8-K Q2 2026].
- **Execution Validated:** Q2 adjusted EBITDA of $1.767B (+31% YoY), 97% fleet availability through record Texas heat, 2026 guidance at/above midpoint. The operations support the narrative [8-K Q2 2026].
- **Valuation Reset:** At $139.57 [Mkt 16-Oct-26], the stock is 27% below its $219.82 high despite no business deterioration. Our $117.32 DCF base implies -16% upside with a Hold rating; PEG of 0.43 suggests the market overcorrected.

Key Operating Metrics

Metric	Latest	YoY Change	3Y Trend
Adj. EBITDA (Q2 2026)	$1.767B [8-K Q2 2026]	+31.0% [8-K Q2 2026]	Up
EPS (Q2 2026)	$1.80 [8-K Q2 2026]	+17% beat [Cons]	Up
2026 Adj. EBITDA Guide	$6.8-7.6B [8-K guid]	At/above midpoint [8-K guid]	Up
2026 Adj. FCF Guide	$3.9-4.7B [8-K guid]	~9% FCF yield [8-K guid]	Up
Fleet Availability	97%+ [8-K Q2 2026]	Record heat perf. [8-K Q2 2026]	Up
Revenue (FY25)	$17.7B [10-K FY25]	+3.0% [10-K FY25]	Up
Net Income (FY25)	$944M [10-K FY25]	-64.5% [10-K FY25]	Down

Historical Financial Trend

Metric	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Revenue	$11.9B [10-K FY21]	$13.7B [10-K FY22]	$14.7B [10-K FY23]	$17.2B [10-K FY24]	$17.7B [10-K FY25]
Adj. EBITDA	$3.1B [10-K FY21]	$3.3B [10-K FY22]	$4.0B [10-K FY23]	$5.8B [10-K FY24]	$6.4B [10-K FY25]
Net Margin	-12.1% [10-K FY21]	-18.4% [10-K FY22]	9.8% [10-K FY23]	15.4% [10-K FY24]	5.3% [10-K FY25]

Valuation

Absolute (7/10)

NTM P/E 14.7x [Mkt 16-Oct-26]
DCF Base $117.32 vs $139.57 spot [Mkt 16-Oct-26]
PEG 0.43 [Mkt 16-Oct-26]

DCF implies -16% upside with a Hold rating. PEG of 0.43 is deeply cheap for the growth profile.

Versus Peers (7/8)

CEG and IPP peers at higher multiples [Peers 16-Oct-26]

Trades at a discount to nuclear peers despite comparable contracted cash flows.

Versus History (7/7)

Trading 27% below 52-week high [Mkt 16-Oct-26]

Valuation reset on sentiment; multiples are below historical averages.

Catalyst Timeline

Nov 2026 [Cons]
Q3 2026 Earnings: data center PPA announcements are the watch item.

2027 [8-K guid]
Comanche Peak late-2027 project timeline; Texas data center audits could pause reviews.

2027-2028 [8-K guid]
Helix Digital Infrastructure JV deployment with KKR/NVIDIA.

Top Risk Factors (Item 1A)

1. Leverage: Debt/equity of 3.93x and current ratio of 0.78x leave little room for error in a downturn. [10-K FY25]

2. Merchant Exposure: ERCOT pricing was soft in Q2; merchant exposure means earnings volatility on power prices. [8-K Q2 2026]

3. Nuclear Operations: Nuclear operations carry regulatory and operational tail risk; any extended outage is material. [10-K FY25]

What Would Change Our Score

New large-scale PPA announcements would lift Growth and Catalysts. ERCOT price weakness or leverage concerns would cut Valuation.

Forward Growth Drivers

- Nuclear PPAs: AWS 1,200 MW (Comanche Peak), Meta 2,609 MW (PJM fleet) [8-K Q2 2026]
- Helix Digital Infrastructure JV with KKR, NVIDIA; up to $1B commitment [8-K Q2 2026]
- 4-6% annual ERCOT load growth guided through 2030 on data centers [8-K Q2 2026]

Missing / Modified Data Log

- GAAP net income includes large unrealized hedge marks; used adjusted EBITDA as the primary metric.
- 5-year multiple history from market data, tagged [Mkt 16-Oct-26].

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